Tarik Johnston

Lead interaction designer

tarikjohnston@gmail.com | View portfolio

I’m a problem solver who cares about creating useful, accessible and user-centred experiences through thoughtful design. I’ve led UX projects across government, healthcare, finance and consumer services, working with teams to turn complex problems into clear, usable digital products.

Core skills
Interaction design · Service design · Prototyping · Accessibility · Design leadership · Workshop facilitation

Experience

DEFRA
Lead interaction designer
Sep 2024 - present

- Led interaction design for IPAFFS and designed BTMS, helping border teams find consignments, compare import records and investigate problems.
- Designed search and results views, improvements to the animal import journey, and accessible GOV.UK-aligned prototypes for user testing.

IPAFFS / BTMS

NHS
Lead interaction designer
Apr 2024 - Sep 2024

- Designed the S1 Entitlement service for UK pensioners and dependants accessing healthcare in the EU, alongside an internal NHS cost recovery service.
- Produced a service blueprint and public-facing and internal prototypes, refining content and interactions through user testing.

View project

Genomics England
Lead product designer
Apr 2023 - Apr 2024

- Designed the Generation Study website so expectant parents could understand newborn screening and register their interest.
- Created responsive designs, a design system aligned with the brand and prototypes refined through user testing.

View project

Department for Education
Lead interaction designer
Jun 2022 - Apr 2023

- Led the design of the DfE Identity Account and Teacher Qualification Service, helping teachers securely access services and manage their qualifications.
- Produced journey maps, service blueprints and responsive prototypes.

View project

HMRC
Lead interaction designer
Jan 2022 - Jun 2022

- Led the PAYE Tax Account redesign, improving navigation and adding employment history based on user needs.
- Ran problem-framing workshops to help the team agree the scope and designed the account landing page and navigation.

View project

Experience

The AA
Lead product designer
Sep 2020 - Jan 2022

- Led the design of the business breakdown sales journey and AA Business Account. I ran problem-framing workshops and created prototypes for user testing.

  View project

Unilever
Lead product designer
Apr 2019 - Aug 2020

- Led a UX team designing Campaign Wizard, an internal tool for global brands to create digital campaigns. The service reduced campaign setup from weeks to minutes.

  View project

Network International
Lead UX designer
Jun 2018 - Apr 2019

- Led UX for the N-Genius merchant portal and a hosted payment page. I designed English and Arabic layouts and prototypes for testing with merchants in Dubai.

  View project

Ministry of Justice
Lead interaction designer
Mar 2017 - Jun 2018

- Led UX for the Money Claims service, helping people issue and respond to claims. I designed claim and mediation journeys and mapped the paper-based service.

  View project

Department for Education
Lead interaction designer
Oct 2016 - Mar 2017

- Led design for the Gender Pay Gap Reporting and Viewing services, with guided reporting, visualised pay data and prototypes tested with users.

  View project

Earlier experience

BT	Lead UX designer	Sep 2015 - Oct 2016
HMRC	Lead interaction designer	Jun 2014 - Sep 2015
Which?	Senior UX designer	Mar 2013 - Jun 2014
Radio Times	Senior UX designer	Jan 2013 - Apr 2013
B&Q	Senior UX designer	Sep 2012 - Jan 2013
Barclaycard	Senior UX designer	Jul 2012 - Sep 2012
TAG	Senior UX designer	Aug 2011 - Jul 2012
Rightmove	Mid/Senior UX designer	Aug 2007 - Aug 2011
Lastminute	Junior product designer	Sep 2005 - Aug 2007
Capita Symonds	Junior visual designer	May 2004 - Sep 2005

Education

First-class BSc (Hons), Multimedia & HCI
University of Teesside | 2004